PREPARED FOR KATHERINE EMBERLEY · PRESIDENT, SMB

The SMB category isn't shrinking. TELUS's share of the buyer's question is the growth surface.

Small-business owners across Canada are asking specific, purchase-intent telecom questions right now — and the answers they hear are shaping who they call. On questions that name TELUS, TELUS is present and cited well. On questions that describe a need — home-office wireline, flexible data, cost-effective SMB wireless — TELUS is largely absent, and **Bell is gaining ground**. This is a **sales-openable gap**, not a brand problem. Three issues are close-able before end of quarter.

WEEK 16 · WHAT SHIFTED · OCT 12 – OCT 19

Panel-wide 72/100 (up 1 from 71). Biggest mover: SMB cost-effective wireless 58 → 48.

▼	**SMB cost-effective wireless** 58 → 48	*-10pp*
▲	**Flexible mobile data** 16 → 18	*+2pp*
▲	**Family unlimited data** 74 → 88	*+14pp*

01

The top line, in four numbers

50.6 /100
SMB SHARE-OF-ANSWER
5-query aggregate · +1.4 from July · essentially flat WoW (51.0 → 50.6)

2
CATEGORY POSITIONS OWNED
Rural business · business-owner sentiment

3
SALES-OPENABLE ISSUES
Home-office wireline · flex data · SMB wireless

+3
BELL'S SMB SHARE, 30D
Real trend in Rogers mobile queries; SMB view flatter (noise)

02

What SMB buyers are asking, verbatim

Five real Canadian-telco buying questions, tracked weekly across ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity, Google AI Overview and Google AI Mode. TELUS's share-of-answer per question.

BUYER QUESTION	POSITION	TELUS SCORE
Does Telus offer reliable service for rural residents in 2026?	TELUS OWNS	100/100
What do business owners think about using Telus for their company's telecom needs?	TELUS OWNS · RECOVERED	100/100
My small business needs a cost-effective wireless solution with unlimited data.	CATEGORY GAP · −5 WOW	35/100
Are there flexible mobile data plans I can adjust monthly based on usage?	CATEGORY GAP · −3 WOW	8/100
Buy best wireline solution for my home office setup.	CATEGORY GAP	10/100

The pattern. TELUS wins where the buyer names TELUS. TELUS loses where the buyer describes a need. The three "category gap" questions are the sales-openable ones — a small-business buyer expressing purchase intent, and Bell / Rogers / Reddit threads filling the answer.

03

Three issues to close before Q4 26

Each closable with a product/merchandising move on the TELUS side and a matching content presence intervention on ours. Numbers show current share-of-answer and plausible ceiling if closed.

1 · Home-office wireline has no TELUS story in the AI answer

10 → TARGET 45

"Buy best wireline solution for my home office setup."

Cited sources are Reddit r/canadianISPs, PlanHub comparison pages, and Bell's business fiber pages. **No packaged "Home Office" bundle SKU shows up.** TELUS Business Internet is present but not merchandised for the home-office buyer.

THE PLAY Package and merchandise a **TELUS Home Office Fiber** bundle — priority service, business-grade uptime, one-line billing. Content on telus.com/business, Reddit r/canadianISPs presence, WhistleOut & PlanHub listing updates. **Expected lift:** 40–50 within 6 weeks of consistent presence.

2 · Flex / variable data isn't a named TELUS product

8 → TARGET 40

"Are there flexible mobile data plans I can adjust monthly based on usage?"

Freedom Mobile and Rogers Infinite are the most-cited answers. Bell shows up on business-flex language. TELUS doesn't have a product name the AI can index.

THE PLAY Launch or reposition a named **TELUS Business Flex Data** plan. Front-load PR + comparison-site coverage. **Expected lift:** 30–40 within one measurement cycle after content lands.

3 · SMB Essentials has real momentum — accelerate it

35 → TARGET 65

"My small business needs a cost-effective wireless solution with unlimited data."

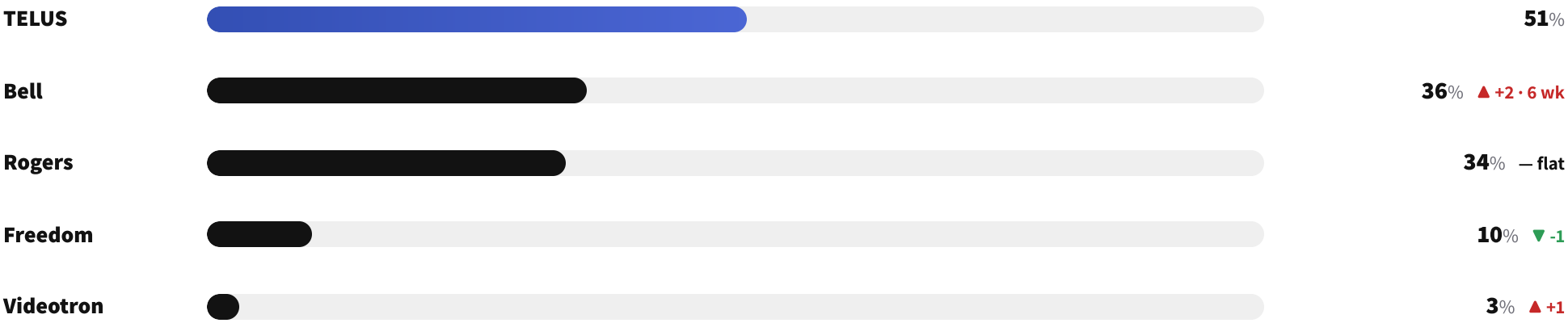
TELUS is *already* in the answer 40% of the time — up from 32 in July. Rogers, Bell, and Public Mobile take the rest. **The SMB Essentials tier isn't consistently cited by name.**

— THE PLAY Sharpen SMB Essentials naming and pricing clarity; refresh WhistleOut / PlanHub listings; seed a Reddit thread with a TELUS Business rep. **Expected lift:** 60–65 within 8 weeks.

— 04

The competitive pattern in the SMB space

Who else shows up in the answers to these five SMB questions.



Watch signal: Bell moved from 34 to 36 in the same SMB space over six weeks. Not alarming, not accidental — Bell's business content strategy has picked up. Worth a competitive audit before end of month.

05

Where SMB buyers get the answers they hear

Top domains the five AI models cite when answering these questions. Influence = citation frequency × answer prominence.

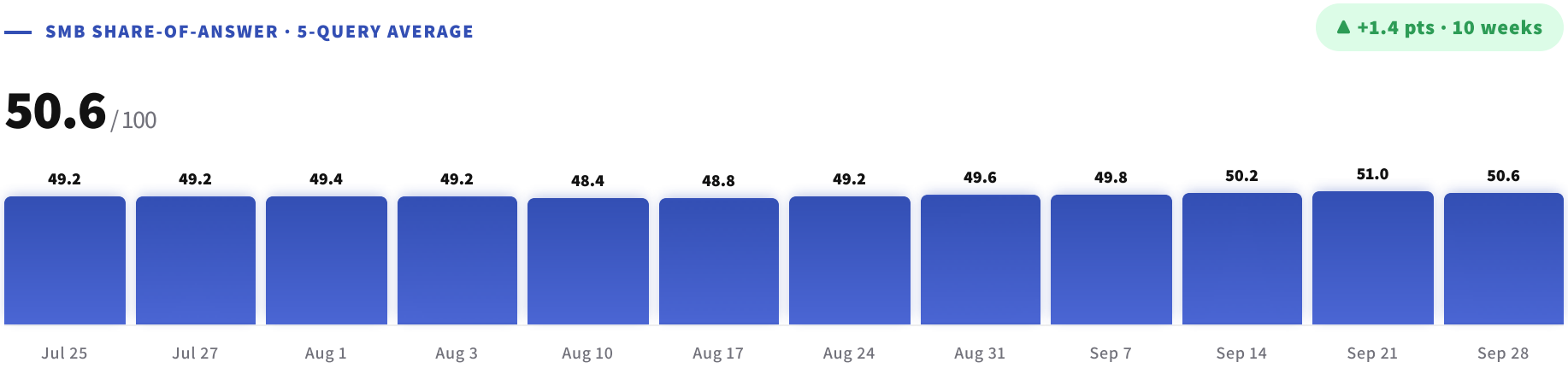
reddit.com 85	telus.com 62	facebook.com 55	whistleout.ca 54	youtube.com 52	bell.ca 48	opensignal.com 48
forum.telus.com 43	planhub.ca 43	ca.trustpilot.com 43				

Three sales-useful takeaways. Reddit dominates. When an AI picks who to recommend for SMB, Reddit shapes it more than any brand's own site. **bell.ca out-influences telus.com/business** for these queries — Bell is showing up on its own domain more than TELUS is on its own. **WhistleOut and PlanHub** are the comparison-site layer the AIs cite; updating TELUS listings there is one of the cheapest interventions with measurable answer-share lift.

06

The trajectory — the one number to watch

Aggregate SMB share-of-answer across all five questions, weekly. Slow, positive, real.



How to read it. A 1.8-point lift over 9 weeks is real signal — much larger than measurement noise — and maps to SMB Essentials gaining on the "cost-effective wireless" query. Closing any one of the three issues in Section 03 would show up as a 3–5 point step-change inside two months.

07

What this looks like as a president's decision

Five resource moves that convert insight into Q4 pipeline. None require net-new headcount. All are inside a president's authority.

	MOVE	FROM → TO	SIGNAL IN
1	**Reweight SMB digital media brand → intent** 15–20% shift from broad brand awareness to paid + content targeting the 5 tracked SMB questions verbatim.	Brand awareness → question-shaped intent	4–6 wk
2	**Give the flex-data buyer a named product** Reposition an existing SKU as *TELUS Business Flex Data*. Launch page, comparison-site listings, PR moment.	Undifferentiated plan → indexable product	6–8 wk
3	**Package the home-office wireline bundle** SKU + merchandising sprint. No network build, no capex. Highest ceiling of any move.	Generic wireline → Home Office Fiber	6–10 wk
4	**Weight Q4 SMB comp toward the three gap plays** Bonus multiplier on Home Office Fiber, Flex Data, SMB Essentials conversions. One-quarter incentive tweak.	Uniform SMB comp → weighted for gap plays	4 wk
5	**Fund a small "answer surface" capability inside SMB** Standing panel subscription + 1 FTE or partner for comparison-site + community presence. Sub-$200K annual.	Ad-hoc insight → durable read + response layer	Ongoing

The presidential summary

BUNDLED Q4 EXECUTION

One media reweight. One product name. One bundled SKU. One quarterly comp tweak. One standing panel subscription. Nothing requires cross-function approval on the biggest lever, nothing adds SMB headcount. Executed as a bundle in October, the aggregate SMB score moves from **51** toward **60** by end of Q1 27 — and the mix of what TELUS sells inside SMB shifts toward the higher-margin, higher-intent categories already showing up in the buyer's own question.

08

Methodology, for the room

The panel. 20 realistic Canadian-telco buying questions asked every Monday of 5 AI systems — ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity, Google AI Overview, Google AI Mode. Results appended to a durable, append-only tracking store. Running since July 17, 2026 — 16 weekly pulls on record.

The SMB slice. 5 of the 20 questions are SMB-relevant: home-office wireline, flexible mobile data, cost-effective SMB wireless, business-owner sentiment on TELUS, rural-business reliability. This scorecard filters the panel to those five; the aggregate is a simple unweighted average.

Share-of-answer. % of AI responses in which the brand appears as a substantive mention or citation, within the measured window. A score of 40 on a question means TELUS appears in 40% of the responses to that question.

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